

Parks Department Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=B9niZMZJpdM
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1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearing or committee session was held prior to the regular meeting.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** 00:00:12 Presiding officer called to order the Muncie Parks & Recreation Board meeting on July 16th.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Shannon Powers, Brad Marshall
 - **Members Absent:** Chandra Parks, James Long, Mark Irvin
 - **Presiding Officer:** Brad Marshall (noted that a quorum was not present, meaning formal votes and informational discussions requiring a quorum could not occur).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** 00:00:12 Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** 00:01:11 The prior meeting's minutes were tabled until the next meeting due to the lack of a quorum.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

(Note: Because the board lacked a quorum, no formal votes were taken on any items during this meeting.)

- **00:01:18 Superintendent Report**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone, Parks Superintendent.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Superintendent Malone provided updates on park beautification and maintenance. Four rain gardens were removed and cleaned up at McCullum Park. Upkeep is ongoing at Thomas, Hein, Riverview, and Cohen Parks. At Riverview Park, the shelter is fully installed, the pickleball court is 90% complete, a large barbecue grill was installed, but there is still no completion timeline for the restroom. At Thomas Park, a new splash pad is up and running, but the park continues to face severe issues with vandalism (doors kicked in) and homeless individuals camping out in restrooms, raising safety concerns. At Hein Park, plumbing work has been completed to provide a running restroom for staff and tournaments, and drinking water is restored. At McCullum Park, Community Development finished exterior/interior work on the cabin, but a water leak near the rear north corner requires investigation to protect the foundation.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no vote taken.

- **00:09:13 Prairie Creek Report**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Prairie Creek staff representative.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Covered wrap-up of two major events: the 4th of July Ron Bonam Days and Iron Man. Noted heavy traffic and the temporary closure of the north gate and campground entrance by police to manage traffic flow. A serious restroom incident during Ron Bonam Days was handled, and the involved individuals have been blacklisted. The department is addressing third-party security communication gaps (exploring walkie-talkies or dedicated phone numbers). Met with the sailboat club and fishermen regarding a proposed fishing pier location to avoid protected areas. Noted that a campground north gate was struck and damaged by a vehicle around midnight on Saturday; security cameras on the gate were non-functional, and local police reported limited jurisdiction/action since the suspect left. Discussed ongoing jurisdictional confusion between city and county police departments regarding reservoir calls.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** Comments received from attendees regarding safety, traffic speeds, and security presence.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no vote taken.

- **00:24:38 Parks Programming & Events Report**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** George Foley, Parks Programming Director.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Highlighted summer programs, including a quarterback/receiver football camp at Ball Corp (approx. 40 kids), the Black Music Month celebration at McCullum Park on June 29th, and a “Willing to Ride” bike safety program with the Girls Coalition of Indiana (teaching 25 girls bike safety, culminating in a ride in the Black Expo parade). The Muncie Teen Internship Program is wrapping up its final week; teens participated in mentorship days, built shelters at Hein and Cohen Parks, created cornhole sets, and painted park bathrooms. Mentioned upcoming events including music in the park, a youth basketball tournament, a car/bike show, and an August 6th backpack/school supply giveaway at McCullum Park in partnership with Walmart, NAACP, and Delta Sigma Theta.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; event requests for the Industry Neighborhood Association (August 10) and Southside Neighborhood Association (August 27) were deferred to administrative approval by the Superintendent due to the lack of a quorum, to be officially ratified next month.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:35:34 Jackie Cisco** (President, Friends of Prairie Creek)
 - Addressed the board regarding the online community survey results sent to management, upcoming meetings (August 9), and a blind draw cornhole tournament scheduled for August 17 at the community building (no alcohol permitted). Emphasized ongoing camper concerns regarding security, gate damage, and lack of police response.
 - **00:37:56 Nathan Buck** (Campground Resident / Citizen)
 - Spoke about witnessing the gate being struck by a vehicle and the slow response time of law enforcement (approx. 30 minutes). Expressed safety concerns regarding vehicles speeding through campsites (35-40 mph) on the 4th of July, suggesting interior campground roads be gated off during major events. Also suggested trimming invasive honeysuckle brush along the shoreline near docks to improve visibility and deter theft.
 - **00:52:25 Troy Chester** (Resident)
 - Questioned municipal spending priorities regarding security at city facilities versus parks. Voiced concerns over homeless individuals frequenting Thomas Park near the splash pad, potential vandalism of newly invested tax dollars, and slow police response times in neighborhoods. Also questioned an alleged \$7,000 Board of Works allocation for Thomas Park.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Shannon Powers noted an upcoming presentation to IU Health corporate on August 15 regarding a grant proposal for a year-round expansion of the Teen and Mentorship Program.
 - Shannon Powers and George Foley are reviewing and piloting a survey for the upcoming 5-year master plan renewal.
- **Adjournment:** 00:58:02 Meeting officially adjourned following a motion and call to adjourn.

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